

October 23 - 9:30 p.m.

Dear Margaret I wanted to tell you of at least a few other remarkable cases - answers to prayers especially in connection with the wonderful Seraphic Mass Association. Incidentally, in which we enrolled you and Frank after receiving your letter about a week ago. I hoped to get this off to you before the middle of the week, and here it (is) Saturday night just striking ten. Glory be to God!

October 26, 9:20 P.M. According to the baptismal certificate ... I was 84 yesterday. Deo Gr! ... Deo Grt! Dear Margaret: I hardly think I ever told you about our enrolling companys and projects in the Seraphic Mass As'n. The following - first in several similar to it since - I am sure will please you.

The slump of 1926-25-Winter was tough one on Detroiters. Every Auto factory in the city shut down for at least a week at Christmas, without a word when they would start up again. Only a day or two before New Years was it announced that Ford would start up again, such and such a day after New Years and would continue at three days a week till further notice. That was quite a "beam of hope" for perhaps millions. The other auto-companies followed lingeringly, but most of them just one and two days each week - one of the slowest seemingly, the Chevrolet, which as we learned only a year or two later, had already started negotiations towards bankruptcy. ... On the 12th of February, Thursday about 9 p.m., John McKenna who had become enthusiastic about the Ser. Mass Asso'n the first months after my arrival back from New York, August 1st, 1924, came to the Office. He was evidently discouraged, notwithstanding his otherwise wonderful Faith.

"Father", he began, "I don't know what to do; I can't support a wife and family the () I've been working. I haven't had a full day now in two weeks; and To-Day I had only two hours. ... They'er always finding an alibi to send the men home." All at once as tho by inspiration: "Father! Enroll the Company! ?" "That's new", thought I. 20 times quicker than I could tell it, however, so that it seemed absurd to hesitate, flashed on my mind: "If a single Holy Mass must help any legitimate cause, why should not five hundred Masses daily in connection with the holy foreign Missions help?" "Alright John, " I answered. "yes Father; I'll give them fifty cents. ... That same night the Company received an astounding order. Two nights later McK. waved in triumphantly: "Father! we had over-time yesterday and To-Day and we heard this after-noon: the Co. has an order for 45000 machines, wanted in thirty days". ...It was believed: that order saved Det. itself from bankruptcy. Pl. Pardon such patchwork - longer than intended.

Fr. Solanus, O.F.M.Cap.